An example of the whole process is shown in figure 17.5: as you can see, I was not exaggerating about how chaotic it looks!

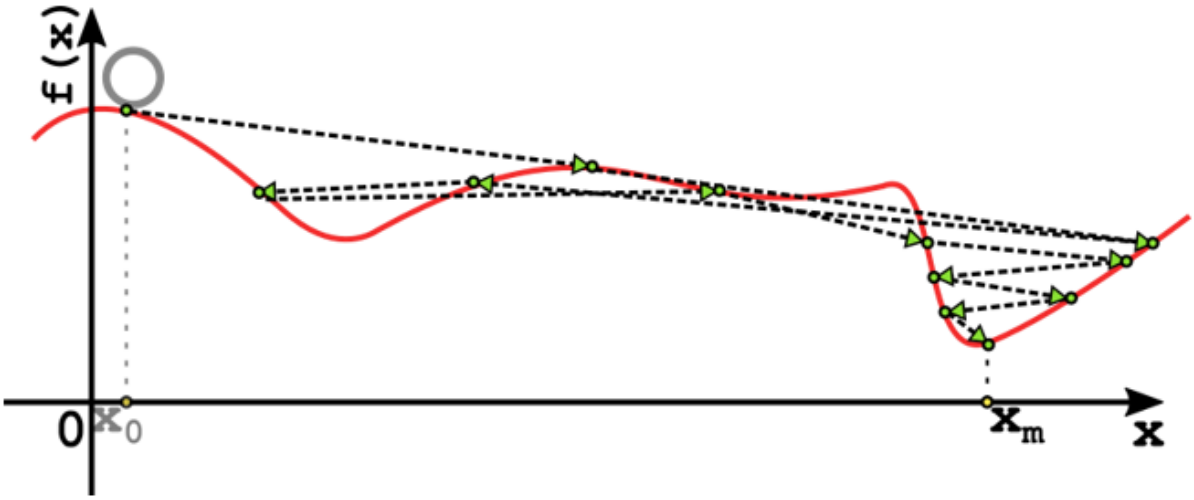


Figure 17.5 A more realistic example of a possible simulated annealing path to the minimum, for a function of a single parameter. Initially steps are larger and the probability to accept a worse result is higher; as the cooling progresses, fine-tuning kicks-in, with smaller steps only (or mostly) towards better results.

17.1.2 Implementation

So, enough talking about how cool this algorithm is, let's take a look at some (pseudo)code[7]: listing 17.1 presents the algorithm.

The algorithm looks beautifully simple, doesn't it? And quite concise although, as always, we try to present generic methods as templates, and when possible, we abstract as